18.9 Aggressive Behavior*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Leave me alone or I will hit you." **Objective** • Shouting; fists clenched • Pacing	**ACTUAL** Ineffective impulse control related to anger and maladaptive coping as evidenced by threats and agitation.	• Expresses anger in words.	• Approach calmly, with an open posture, keeping a safe distance. • De-escalate: listen, acknowledge feelings, offer choices. • Reduce stimulation and move others away. • Give medication as prescribed if needed.	• Outcome reached when anger is expressed safely.
Subjective • "Nobody listens to me." **Objective** • Frustrated • Shouts when requests are refused	**ACTUAL** Maladaptive coping related to frustration as evidenced by aggressive outbursts.	• Names two other ways to handle anger.	• Talk through the triggers once he is calm. • Teach anger-management techniques. • Encourage him each time he uses them.	• Considered met when alternatives are used.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • History of violence	**RISK** Risk for other-directed violence as evidenced by risk factors: history of violence and current agitation.	• No harm to self or others.	• Use restraint or seclusion only as a last resort and as policy permits. • Document behavior and interventions. • Debrief after any incident.	• Goal reached if no harm occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [31], [35], [74]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.